



A FAMILY CHRONICLE

Our Family & Where We Came From

*From Nikolief to Chicago, Appleton, Flagstaff, Phoenix, and
the generations gathered around Lois.*

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The Crossing

Long before any of us were here, there was a tailor in a Russian town called Nikolief, or Nikolaev, who made uniforms for the Tsar's army. His name was David Moses Ressman, and he would whip his children to say their prayers, then have them help him sew. His wife was Hinda Pessin, daughter of a chazan and shochet, sister of a magid, a storyteller. She came from a learned family.

Hinda was deaf. She had been blinded in one eye as a girl when a kite struck her face during play. As a young woman, Cossacks had clubbed her about the head, and that may have had something to do with the deafness too. But she carried thirteen children, seven of whom lived, and she kept the family together long enough to send them, one by one, across the ocean to a country none of them had ever seen.

During the voyage, the children were passed up over a gate to spend a little time with their grandparents.

The first to make the journey was Ed Ressman, David Moses's brother, who landed in Chicago, then moved north to Appleton, Wisconsin. Beginning around 1890, he conducted minyans and religious services in his own home. That living-room beginning became part of the story of Moses Montefiore Congregation.

In 1902, Abram and Joseph Ressman crossed with their wives and children. In 1903, the rest came: David Moses and Hinda themselves, with Rachel and her children. The Ressmans traveled tourist class. Rachel and her children traveled steerage. The boat may have been called the Saxonia. It landed in Baltimore. From there, they took the train to Chicago.

They founded a company called Acme Manufacturing that made parts of suits, but there was so much fighting within the family that the business did not last. Every Ressman brother worked in the tailoring trade. Rachel scrubbed floors for fifty cents apiece. They were tired and they were poor and they were here, and that is where this story actually begins.

The Seven Who Survived

David Moses and Hinda had thirteen children, but seven lived. The scanned family history also resolves Leon's place inside this core Ressman line.

Rachel Ressman

Beilen/Bailin

1865–1954

The eldest. Crossed in 1903 with her children after David Beilen came ahead; raised the Bailin branch in Chicago after his death.

Joseph Ressman

1867/1873–1949

Married Jennie Joseph. Their seven daughters stayed mostly in the Chicago area, except Lottie, who settled in Neenah, Wisconsin.

Abram Ressman

DATES TO VERIFY

A tailor in Odessa before immigration. The scanned history says he and Celia had no children; later he married Carrie Cohen.

Louis Ressman

1882–1969

Married Ida Cohen. The expanded branch adds Jeanette, David, Esther, and Harry Ressman.

***Rebecca Ressman
Bahcall***

1881–1973

Gave her passage ticket to Isadore Bahcall, then married him in Appleton, where the Bahcall business line grew.

Harry Ressman

1885/1886–1976

Moved to Appleton on his honeymoon with Sarah Spector and built Ressman's Clothiers across generations.

Leon Ressman

1890–1971

No longer an uncertain outside branch. The scanned history names Leon as the youngest surviving child of David Moses and Hinda.

The Bloodline to Lois

The Old Country

David Moses Ressman

1849–1925 · TAILOR IN NIKOLIEF / NIKOLAEV

Made uniforms for the Tsar's army. Immigrated through Baltimore in 1903 and died in Chicago. Father of thirteen children, seven of whom survived.

Hinda Pessin Ressman

1850–1937 · DAUGHTER OF A CHAZAN

Deaf. Blinded in one eye by a kite. Clubbed by Cossacks. Carried thirteen children, raised seven, and crossed an ocean. Her father was remembered as a chazan and shochet; her brother Nathan, a magid.

The First American Generation

Leon Ressman

1890–1971 · TAILOR → CLEANER → CLOTHIER

Came from Russia at age ten. Sent young to work in his older brothers' tailor shops. Eventually opened a cleaning plant in Pontiac, Illinois — until the gasoline fumes made him ill.

Rose Vanetsky Ressman

1889–1975 · HIS WIFE

Only child of Louis Vanetsky (a junk peddler with a horse and wagon in Englewood) and Machla Rifkin. Fell off a second-floor porch at nine and broke her knee. Slight limp her whole life — never slowed her down.

Born American

Sylvia Ressman Slafer

MAY 28, 1910 – 2006 · BORN IN PONTIAC, ILLINOIS

First child of Leon and Rose. Born during a year the family had moved 90 miles south of Chicago for work. Lived through the Depression with her parents and siblings on Montrose Avenue, Chicago.

Marcus Slaferman / Slafer

1907/1909–1983 · DRESS PATTERN GRADER

Shortened the family name from 'Slaferman' to 'Slafer.' Father of Howard (1939) and Lois (1946).

The Heart of It

Lois Ann Slafer Miller

MAY 27, 1946 — CHICAGO, ILLINOIS · MOTHER. TRAVEL CONSULTANT. PHOENIX, ARIZONA.

Married Joel F. Miller on October 21, 1972 in Chicago. Mother of Maizie, Russell, and Ilene. Grandmother of Jacob and Landon. The center of this whole story.

Yours

Maizie Lee Miller

SEPTEMBER 15, 1973 — TEL AVIV, ISRAEL · ELDEST

Born during her parents' time abroad.

Russell Jasun Miller

JANUARY 15, 1978 — PHOENIX, ARIZONA · MIDDLE CHILD

Eventually a Navy physician — but that's a different chapter.

Michaela Diane Brune Miller

HIS WIFE · MOTHER OF JACOB AND LANDON

Married Russell. Mother of Jacob and Landon.

Ilene Davida Miller

MAY 14, 1980 — PHOENIX, ARIZONA · YOUNGEST

The third star.

Mom's Grandchildren

Jacob Shaz Miller

JUNE 19, 2013 · RUSSELL & MICHAELA'S ELDEST SON

The first of the next generation. Mom's grandson.

Landon Andrew Miller

NOVEMBER 5, 2014 · RUSSELL & MICHAELA'S YOUNGER SON

The second of the next generation. Mom's grandson.

Ozzie Boswell Miller

C. 2009–2025 · LOIS'S GRANDDOG. FAMILY GRANDCHILD.

Passed in 2025 at age 16. Loved as one of the grandchildren, and part of the Miller family story in his own sweet way.

Hinda & the Cossacks

From the Old Country

Hinda Pessin was born into a learned family in Russia. Her father, Harry Pessin, was a chazan and shochet. Her brother Nathan was a magid — a storyteller. Her mother was Esther Skolnick Pessin. They were, by the family's own account, "a well-educated family."

But the world she was born into was not kind to Jewish women, and Hinda's life carried scars from it. She was *deaf* — a condition some of her children would inherit in lesser degree. She had been *blinded in one eye* as a child when a kite some children were playing with struck her in the face. And as a young woman, she had been *clubbed about the head by Cossacks*, which the family always suspected may have contributed to her deafness.

She married a tailor named David Moses Ressman in Nikolief, where he made uniforms for the Tsar's army. They had thirteen children. Only seven survived. And eventually, in 1903, she boarded a boat with the children who had lived and crossed the Atlantic to a country whose language she did not speak.

If you want to know where the family's stubbornness comes from — its refusal to be diminished — it comes from Hinda.

Tea From a Saucer

How Rose Met Leon

Rose Vanetsky was the only child of Louis and Machla Vanetsky. Louis was a junk peddler who rode his horse and wagon through the Englewood neighborhood of Chicago, buying and selling. They never had a lot of money, and like many families of the time, they kept a boarder in the house to help pay the rent.

One day when Rose was about sixteen, Leon Ressman — the youngest of David Moses's seven surviving children — came by the house with friends. Rose was sitting on her mother's lap drinking tea out of a saucer. The way the family told it, *he wasn't very impressed with her, and thought she acted like a baby.*

Still, they started dating. When they were both nineteen, they had a big wedding. In those days, the bride's family did the work — Grandma Vanetsky even *plucked all the chickens* for the dinner.

That was 1909. Their first child, Sylvia — your grandmother — was born the next May.

The Saxonia

The Crossing, 1903

It happened in two waves. In 1902, Abram Ressman and his wife Celia, and Joseph Ressman and his wife Jennie, with their children, crossed the Atlantic with Rachel's husband David Beilen ahead of her. The next year, in 1903, Rachel followed with the children — and David Moses Ressman and Hinda came too, with the rest of the family.

The Ressmans had managed to afford *tourist class*. Rachel and her children, however, traveled in *steerage*, in the cramped lower decks where most immigrants spent the journey.

What the family remembered most about that voyage was a small, tender thing: *during the voyage, the children were passed up over a gate to spend a little time with their grandparents*. Imagine that scene — the boat rolling, the salt wind, hands reaching down through the bars to lift up a child for a moment.

The boat may have been the *Saxonia*. It docked in Baltimore. From there, the family rode the train to Chicago, where they would settle, fight, fail in business, succeed in business, and put down the roots that would eventually carry their name into your kitchen in Phoenix.

Moses Montefiore Congregation

Appleton, Wisconsin

Edward "Ed" Ressman — David Moses's brother — was the first of the family to come to America. He arrived as a peddler and scrap dealer with his wife Sonya Hirshkovitz. They settled first in Chicago, then moved north to Appleton, Wisconsin, where Sonya had relatives, the Greenbergs.

Appleton, in the late nineteenth century, had a small Jewish community but no synagogue. Ed solved that problem the way the family solved most problems: by doing it himself. Beginning around 1890, he conducted minyans and religious services in his own home. He owned his own Torahs, and the early peddlers, the only other Orthodox Jews of the city, attended.

The Moses Montefiore Congregation was officially founded in 1903. Its first officers included President David Belzer, Vice President Abe Levin, Secretary A. L. Jacobson, and Treasurer *Isadore Bahcall* — the same Isadore who came to America after Rebecca Ressman gave him her ticket.

In 1910, Aaron Zussman came to Appleton with his family and became cantor, teacher, shochet, and spiritual leader. A synagogue was built on the corner of *Atlantic and Bateman streets* in 1922 and dedicated on June 10, 1923. The congregation later joined United Synagogues of America in 1965, moved to a modern North Meade Street building in 1970, and continues as part of Jewish life in the Fox Valley.

So the story is larger than one living room. It is Ed's home, Isadore's treasury, a Bateman Street synagogue, and a community that kept adapting for more than a century.

Rachel Scrubbed Floors

First Years in Chicago

The Ressmans landed in Baltimore and made their way to Chicago, where the rest of the family had already begun to settle. They were tailors. That's all they had ever been. So they did what tailors do: they founded a company.

It was called *Acme Manufacturing*, and it made parts of suits. The Ressman brothers — Abram, Louis, Joseph, Harry, Leon — all worked in it. But there was, the family said with characteristic plainness, *so much fighting within the family that the business didn't last*.

When Acme failed, the brothers scattered. *All the Ressman brothers worked in the tailoring trade*. Rachel — the eldest — took whatever work she could get, including *scrubbing floors for fifty cents*.

Harry Ressman went to work for Hart, Schaffner & Marx, a major manufacturer of men's clothing. There he met another employee, Sarah Spector, and married her. On their honeymoon, they visited Harry's sister Rebecca Bahcall in Appleton. They liked it. They had no money and no jobs, but they stayed — and eventually opened a clothing store of their own called *Ressman's Clothiers*. That store still operates today, run by Harry's grandson Alan Rusky.

The Cleaning Plant

Pontiac, Illinois

After Leon and Rose married in 1909 and Sylvia was born the next May, Leon decided to leave Chicago. The labor problems in the clothing industry were too much for him, and he wanted something of his own.

They moved ninety miles south, to a small town called Pontiac, Illinois — the county seat, with about six Jewish families. Leon opened a *cleaning and dyeing plant*. His first machines were operated by hand. He worked very hard. Eventually he opened a plant on the main street of town, and the business succeeded.

Two and a half years after Sylvia was born came Ruth, then a son, Ezra. The Sacks and the Moshines were the closest families — they got together for every Holiday and weekend.

But by the time Sylvia was about ten, Leon was getting *ill from the gasoline fumes* he worked with every day. They had to leave. Leon's cousin Joe Bailen suggested Green Bay, Wisconsin, where they could open a clothing store together. So they went.

The Green Bay store failed in the Depression. They came back to Chicago. Leon opened a tailor shop at 3253 W. Montrose Avenue, with the family living in a small apartment behind the store. Sylvia went to high school. Ruth and Ezra to grammar school. *Those were struggling years, but we were a very happy family*, Sylvia would say later, *and never really thought that we were missing very much.*

Sylvia & the Porch

Your Grandmother

Sylvia Ressman — your grandmother — was born May 28, 1910 in Pontiac, Illinois, the firstborn of Leon and Rose. By every account, she had a happy childhood. The cleaning plant was doing well. The town was small, the Jewish community close.

One day, when she was about nine, she fell off a second-floor porch. They didn't know until some time later that she had *broken her kneecap*. She had many operations on that knee, but came through them all.

The ankle gave her trouble, the family said, because *she wanted to do the things the other girls did, and used her leg too much*. She had a slight limp her whole life. And, the record notes simply: *it never stopped her from raising her three children, and doing all the things that a housewife in those days had to do to maintain a busy household*.

She had, the family also remembered, a good singing voice. And she was very good at arithmetic.

That toughness — the refusal to let a broken knee define a life — is the same toughness that came through Hinda from Russia, that carried Rose through the Depression, and that you carried into your own life. It runs in the line.

Ezra Sent His Pay Home

World War II

Ezra Ressman — Sylvia and Ruth's younger brother — went to the University of Illinois downstate. Ruth and Sylvia worked, and the family helped put their brother through college. Money was hard. These were Depression years.

After his pre-law degree, Ezra continued at DePaul University to study law. He passed the State Bar Exam, became a full-fledged lawyer, and opened a practice with two friends, Mor Levin and Jerry Blonder.

Then the war came.

Ezra *went into service*. He was drafted, where his partners weren't. While he served, he *sent his army pay back home to keep the law office going*. His partners maintained the practice in his absence.

After the war, Ezra's story reached unexpectedly west. He was one of the original investors in *Ramada*, whose first hotel opened on Route 66 in Flagstaff, Arizona in 1954. The family line runs through tailor shops, scrap yards, law offices, and then, somehow, into the motel signs of the American highway.

He never married. He died many years later, having spent his life as a Chicago lawyer — quiet, generous, the kind of man who would mail his army pay back to his partners so the work could go on.

Ressman's Clothiers

Appleton, Wisconsin — Still Open

This is one of the great enduring stories of the family. Harry Ressman went to work for Hart, Schaffner & Marx in Chicago after the closing of Acme Manufacturing. There he met another employee, Sarah Spector, and married her.

On their *honeymoon*, they went to visit Harry's sister Rebecca Bahcall in Appleton, Wisconsin. They liked it so much they decided to stay — *with no money and no jobs*. Harry started doing tailoring work for the people of the town, and eventually they opened a small clothing store called *Ressman's Clothiers*.

They had two daughters, Diana (1910) and Esther "Jere" (1914). Diana married Ben Rusky, a salesman, and they had a son, Alan Rusky, born 1942. When Alan grew up, he came to work in the store — and today, more than a century after that honeymoon visit, *Alan still owns Ressman's Clothiers*. His wife Annette works there too. Their one employee is Jared "Jerry" Bailin, the great-grandson of Harry's sister Rachel.

In 1979, a local newspaper ran a feature with a photograph of Alan Rusky standing in the store, holding up a comically large pair of shorts under the headline "*His undies in a bundle over this.*" The store was thriving even then. It still is.

The Playboy Connection

An Unexpected Branch

Of all the threads that ran out of Appleton, Wisconsin and the family scrap business, this one is perhaps the most unexpected.

Rebecca Ressman — David Moses's daughter, the one who gave her ticket to Isadore Bahcall — settled in Appleton with him after he came over with Rose. They had three children: Rose, Edward, and Sarah "Bebe." Rose Bahcall married Walter Rosenzweig from Bessemer, Michigan. Walter went into the scrap business with his father-in-law. They had two children: Donna (1929) and Richard (1935).

Richard Rosenzweig lived in Chicago for many years before moving to Los Angeles. There, he became *Executive Vice-President of Playboy Enterprises* and *President of Playboy Productions* — the production company involved in television, film, and (at the time of the family record) "preparing video disc systems." He was married twice — to Elaine Fantle and Bonnie Bovac — and divorced from both.

From a tailor in Russia to the Tsar's army to a scrap heap in Appleton, Wisconsin to the executive suite of Playboy Enterprises, in three generations. Only in America.

The Vanetskys

Englewood, Chicago

On your grandmother Rose's side, the story starts in Englewood, on the south side of Chicago, sometime between 1870 and 1880, when *Louis* and *Machla* (*Mary*) *Vanetsky* arrived from somewhere in Russia. Where exactly, no one wrote down.

Rose was their only child. The family had tried to have other children, but none survived birth or early childhood. So Rose grew up an only child, raised in a small home that almost always had a boarder living in it to help pay the rent. Her mother used to tell her that the boarder was *like a big brother to her*; many years later, Rose would still know him and his children.

Louis was a *junk peddler*. He rode his horse and wagon through Englewood, buying scraps from people on the street and selling what he gathered to the junk yards that existed in those days. He was, in Rose's memory, *kind of tall, and always wore a mustache and a little Van Dyke beard*.

Machla was small and plump — Rose's word — with a good singing voice and a head for arithmetic. The family name Rifkin, her maiden name, would echo down the line. She died after surgery for gallbladder disease while the family was living in Green Bay. Louis came to live with the family in Chicago after that.

This is half of where you come from on your mother's side. Junk and scrap and a horse and wagon and an only daughter who fell off a porch and never let it slow her down.

Rachel Beilen

The Eldest, Born 1865

Rachel was the eldest of David Moses and Hinda Ressman's children — born in 1865 in Russia, died in Chicago in 1954 at the age of eighty-nine.

She had married, in Russia, a man named David Beilen, whose father was *a farmer and the mayor of Kolonia (or Bohakuv)*. Her parents had not approved of the match — David was in poor health — but she married him anyway.

David came to America in 1902, a year before Rachel and the children. He went to work for Ed Ressman in Appleton, but didn't like it there, so he moved back to Chicago and worked as a tailor. He went to Denver, hoping the dry air would help his lungs. It didn't. He died there a year later — *of tuberculosis of the throat, at the age of thirty-eight*.

Rachel was left in Chicago with seven children. They were Esther, Bessie, Eva, Joseph, Bertha, Sadie, and Abram. The youngest, Abram, was the only one born in America. When the children were in school, Joseph decided that the family name *Beilen* ought to be spelled the way it was pronounced, so the teachers could read it. They became the *Bailins*, and there are Bailins in this family ever since.

Rachel scrubbed floors for fifty cents apiece. She lived to see grandchildren and great-grandchildren. She is buried in Chicago.

Image Plates



PORTRAIT

Hinda Pessin & David Moses Ressman

The immigrant generation at the center of the Ressman family record.



PORTRAIT

Marcus & Sylvia Slafer

Sylvia Ressman and Marcus Slafer, the Chicago link between Ressman and Miller.



SISTERS

Sylvia & Ruth Ressman

Leon and Rose Ressman's daughters, remembered as part of a close household.



SYNAGOGUE

Bateman Street Synagogue, 1923

Moses Montefiore Congregation built this Appleton synagogue at Atlantic and Bateman streets in 1922 and dedicated it on June 10, 1923.



PORTRAIT

Isadore Bahcall

Rebecca Ressman's fiancé, later husband, and treasurer of Moses Montefiore Congregation when it was officially founded in 1903.



BUSINESS

David Bailin at Eagle Supply & Plastics

A later Appleton business branch growing out of the Bahcall/Bailin scrap-and-supply tradition.



BUSINESS

Acme Manufacturing, Chicago

The family's first American manufacturing venture, remembered as ambitious and short-lived.

Shorts

His undies in a bundle over this

A line in one of the novels of Max Shulman, writer of humor who was popular in the 1950s and '60s, says, "A man's shorts are his castle."

Shulman was a spokesman for his times, but those times have changed. The "designers," those interior decorators of human exteriors, have invaded the castle.

The result of the invasion is that, if you haven't visited the men's underwear department at your favorite store for some time, the next time you do you may think you made a wrong turn somewhere, in life or when you walked in the store.

What are we talking about here? Mostly, we're talking about unmentionables for men. We're talking about skivvies, shorts and BVDs. We're talking about underpants.

For guys who grew up with plain white briefs or baggy boxers, it is more than the future-shocked brain can take. It is a matter of choice most men never asked to make.

A lot of men, for example, weren't happy when suddenly they were faced with the need to decide between 100% cotton and a polyester blend. Underwear is a habitual thing. There's no reason to buy something different as long as what you are buying works. If you don't think about your underwear, it is working.

Most males, by the time they reach puberty, have made the basic decision — briefs or boxers — and

Continued on page 2



Alan Rusky, owner of Ressman Clothiers, and size 58 shorts.

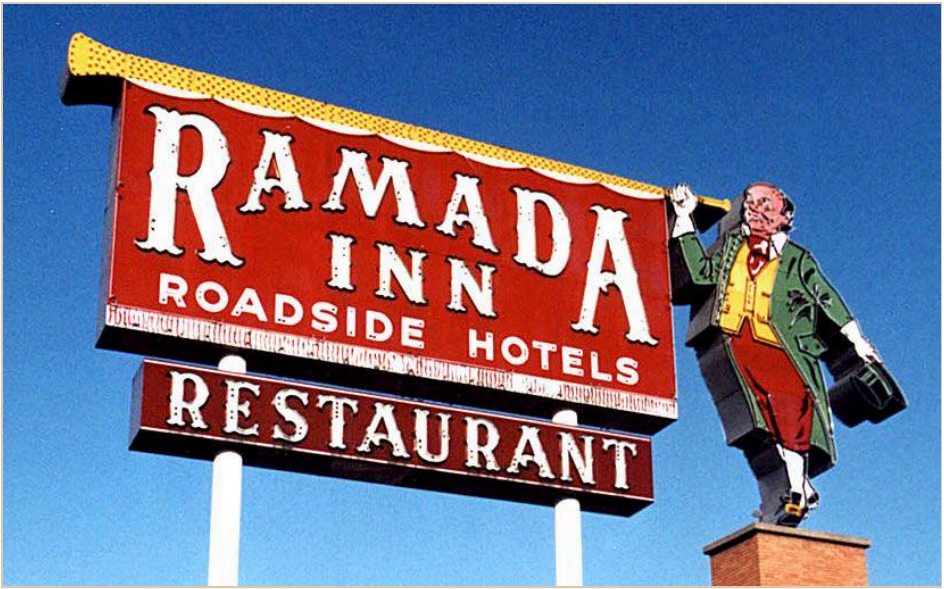
Post-Crescent photo

timehop

CLIPPING

Alan Rusky at Ressman's Clothiers

A newspaper snapshot from the Appleton clothing-store branch.



BUSINESS

First Ramada Inn, Flagstaff

Ezra F. Ressman was one of Ramada's original investors. The first Ramada opened on Route 66 in Flagstaff in 1954.

SERIAL NUMBER **3916** ORDER NUMBER **A 1265**
 1 **Joseph** **Ressmann**
 2 **PERMANENT HOME ADDRESS:** **Alton Mad Ills**
 (No.) (Street or R. F. D. No.) (City or town) (County) (State)
 Age in Years **34** Date of Birth **May 7th 1884**
 (Month) (Day) (Year)
RACE
 White ☒ Negro ☐ Oriental ☐ Indian ☐
 Citizen ☐ Naturalized ☐
 3 ☒ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6 ☐ 7 ☐ 8 ☐ 9 ☐
U. S. CITIZEN **ALIEN**
 Native Born ☒ Naturalized ☐ Citizen by Father's Naturalization ☐ Declarant ☐ Non-declarant ☐
 10 ☒ 11 ☐ 12 ☐ 13 ☐ 14 ☐
 15 Is not a native of the U. S., of what nation are you a citizen or subject?
PRESENT OCCUPATION **EMPLOYER'S NAME**
 16 **Farmer** 17 **Self**
 18 **PLACE OF EMPLOYMENT OR BUSINESS:**
 (No.) (Street or R. F. D. No.) (City or town) (County) (State)
NEAREST RELATIVE 19 **Mother - Caroline Ressmann**
 20 **3 Alton Mad Ills**
 (No.) (Street or R. F. D. No.) (City or town) (County) (State)
 I AFFIRM THAT I HAVE VERIFIED ABOVE ANSWERS AND THAT THEY ARE TRUE
P. M. G. O.
 Form No. 1 (Red) **Joseph Ressman** (OVER)

Joseph Ressman Selective Service Registration

A preserved registration record from the family archive.

Hands That Built



1880S · APPLETON, WISCONSIN

Edward Ressman's Scrap Yard

Founded by David Moses's brother Ed, the first Ressman in America. Took in his niece's fiancé Isadore Bahcall as an employee.

Became I. Bahcall, Inc.



1903 · CHICAGO, ILLINOIS

Acme Manufacturing

The first family business. The Ressman brothers all worked in it, making parts of men's suits. Failed quickly due to family infighting — but every brother went on to a tailoring career.

The first attempt



1909 · PONTIAC, ILLINOIS

Leon's Cleaning & Dyeing

Your great-grandfather Leon's first business. Operated by hand at first, then a real plant on Main Street. Closed when gasoline fumes made him sick.

Closed for his health



1914 · APPLETON, WISCONSIN

Ressman's Clothiers

Founded by Harry Ressman and Sarah Spector on their honeymoon. Still owned and operated today by Harry's grandson Alan Rusky and his wife Annette.

Still open after 110+ years



1920S · APPLETON, WISCONSIN

Bahcall Scrap Metal

Inherited from Ed Ressman by his nephew-in-law Isadore Bahcall. Renamed I. Bahcall, Inc. Sold scrap, then new steel and rubber goods.

Three generations



1924 · 3253 W. MONTROSE AVE, CHICAGO

Leon's Tailor Shop

After the Green Bay clothing store failed in the Depression, Leon opened this small tailor shop in Chicago. The family lived in an apartment behind the store.

Where Sylvia grew up



1930S · APPLETON, WISCONSIN

Sander's Rose Shop

A ladies' clothing store owned by Esther 'Jere' Resslerman's husband Sander Rosenblum, an immigrant from Sweden. Jere helped run the store.

Run by Esther 'Jere'



1958 · APPLETON, WISCONSIN

Eagle Supply & Plastics

Spun off from I. Bahcall, Inc. by Joseph Bailin's son David and son-in-law Ivor Lewis. A continuation of the scrap-and-supply tradition into a new generation.

The next generation



1954 · FLAGSTAFF, ARIZONA

Ezra Ressman & Ramada

Ezra F. Ressman was one of Ramada's original investors. The first Ramada opened on Route 66 in Flagstaff, Arizona in 1954.

Original investor

Records & Corrections

REGISTRATION CARD

SERIAL NUMBER 3916 ORDER NUMBER A 1265

1. Name: Joseph Ressmann

2. Permanent Home Address: Altou Mad Ills

Age in Years: 34 Date of Birth: May 7th 1884

RACE: White

U. S. CITIZEN: Naturalized

13. Native Born: X

14. Present Occupation: Farmer

15. Employer's Name: Self

16. Place of Employment or Business:

17. Nearest Relative: Mother Caroline Ressmann

18. Address: 3 Altou Mad Ills

I AFFIRM THAT I HAVE VERIFIED ABOVE AND THAT THEY ARE TRUE

P. M. G. O. Form No. 1 (Rev.)

RECORD

Joseph Ressman Selective Service Registration

A preserved registration record from the family archive.

Leon Ressman should be treated as the youngest surviving child of David Moses Ressman and Hinda Pessin.

David Moses and Hinda had thirteen children; the scanned history names seven surviving children.

Joseph Bailin and Joe Bailin are likely one person, based on the expanded Rachel Beilen/Bailin branch.

Abram Ressman's branch differs between the older tree and the scanned history and needs original-record reconciliation.

Ezra F. Ressman was one of Ramada's original investors; the first Ramada opened on Route 66 in Flagstaff in 1954.

People Directory

Ressman

Joseph Ressman

Deceased

Earliest known Ressman ancestor in the working tree.

David Moses Ressman

1849–1925

Patriarch. Tailor in Nikolief/Nikolaev, Russia; immigrated through Baltimore in 1903.

Edward 'Ed' Ressman

1841–1905

David Moses's brother. First Ressman in America; conducted minyans and religious services in his Appleton home.

Ida Ressman

Deceased

David Moses and Ed's sister; died in Europe and left a daughter named Rose.

Sonya Hirshkovitz Ressman

?

Ed Ressman's wife.

Rachel Ressman Beilen/Bailin

1865–1954

Eldest daughter. Married David Beilen; mother of the Bailin branch.

Joseph Ressman

1867/1873–1949

Son. Married Jennie Joseph; father of seven daughters.

Abram Ressman

Dates to verify

Son. Tailor in Odessa; married Celia, then Carrie Cohen.

Louis Ressman

1882–1969

Son. Married Ida Cohen. Four children.

Rebecca Ressman Bahcall

1881–1973

Daughter. Gave her ticket to fiancé Isadore Bahcall.

Harry Ressman

1885/1886–1976

Son. Founded Ressman's Clothiers in Appleton.

Leon Ressman

1890–1971

Youngest surviving son. Lois's maternal grandfather.

Sarah Spector Ressman

?

Harry's wife. Met him at Hart, Schaffner & Marx.

Diana Ressman Rusky

1910–?

Harry & Sarah's daughter.

***Esther 'Jere' Ressman
Rosenblum***

1914–?

Harry & Sarah's daughter.

Alan Rusky

1942–

Diana's son. Owner of Ressman's Clothiers, Appleton.

Annette Baron Rusky

?

Alan Rusky's wife. Works in Ressman's Clothiers.

Ruth Ressman Leavitt

1912–2013

Leon & Rose's daughter.

Ezra F. Ressman

1915/1916–1969

Leon & Rose's son. Lawyer in Chicago and one of Ramada's original investors.

Jennie Joseph Ressman

1872–1932

Joseph Ressman's wife. Niece of Rachel's mother-in-law.

Lottie Ressman Burstein

?

Joseph & Jennie's daughter. Lived in Neenah, WI.

Pauline Ressman Berns

?

Joseph & Jennie's daughter.

Rose Ressman Marcus

?

Joseph & Jennie's daughter.

Flora Ressman Richman

?

Joseph & Jennie's daughter.

Dorothy Ressman Abelman

1903–1970

Joseph & Jennie's daughter.

Celia Ressman Less

?

Joseph & Jennie's daughter.

Faye Ressman

?

Joseph & Jennie's youngest. Never married.

Joseph Burstein

?

Lottie Ressman's husband; lived in Neenah, Wisconsin.

Myrtle Burstein

1917–1974

Lottie and Joseph Burstein's daughter.

Victor Burstein

1919–

Lottie and Joseph Burstein's son; foundry owner and former mayor of Albion, Michigan.

Meyer Lewis Burstein

1923–

Lottie and Joseph Burstein's son; economist.

Phillip Berns

?

Pauline Ressman's husband; retail clothing salesman.

Robert Berns

?

Pauline and Phillip Berns's son.

Marvin Berns

1926–

Pauline and Phillip Berns's son; antique dealer.

Alan Marcus

?

Rose Ressman's husband; tailor.

Richard Marcus

1935–

Rose and Alan Marcus's son; insurance business in Los Angeles.

Harry Richman

?

Flora Ressman's husband; salesman.

Byron Richman

1923–

Flora and Harry Richman's son.

Morris Abelman

1901–1959

Dorothy Ressman's husband; wholesale produce business.

Joan Abelman Goldberg

1935–

Dorothy and Morris Abelman's daughter.

Milton Less

?

Celia Ressman's husband; bookkeeper.

Howard Less

1926–

Celia and Milton Less's son.

Donald Less

1930–

Celia and Milton Less's son.

Carrie Cohen Ressman

?

Abram's wife (a widow with a daughter).

Mabel Clorfene

?

Carrie's daughter from previous marriage. Married Henry Clorfene.

Betty Ressman Morse

?

Abram & Carrie's daughter.

Ida Cohen Ressman

?

Louis Ressman's wife.

***Jeanette Ressman
Tenenbaum***

?

Louis & Ida's daughter. Teacher.

David Ressman

?

Louis & Ida's son. Hairdresser in Chicago.

Esther Ressman Rifkin

?

Louis & Ida's daughter.

Harry Ressman (Louis's son)

?

Louis & Ida's son.

Samuel Tenenbaum

?

Jeanette Ressman's husband; hardware-store owner.

***Hinda Sue Tenenbaum
Gilbert***

1938–

Jeanette and Samuel Tenenbaum's daughter; systems analyst.

***Carole Ruth Tenenbaum
Rubenstein***

1940–

Jeanette and Samuel Tenenbaum's daughter; formerly a bacteriologist.

Jeanne Fox Ressman

?

David Ressman's wife.

Richard Bruce Ressman

1941–

David and Jeanne Ressman's son; orthopedic surgeon.

***Lynn Roberta Ressman
Simon***

1944–

David and Jeanne Ressman's daughter.

Nancy Lee Ressman Reil

1952–

David and Jeanne Ressman's daughter.

Hyman B. Rifkin

?

Esther's husband. Wholesale auto parts, Chicago.

Bennett L. Rifkin

1942–

Esther & Hyman's son. Delta Airlines pilot.

Dyann Rifkin Linger

1946–
Esther & Hyman's daughter.

Scott Rifkin

1952–
Esther & Hyman's son.

Helen Shimelforb Ressman

?
Harry's wife (Louis's son).

Laura B. Ressman Fleming

1950–
Harry & Helen's daughter.

Anne L. Ressman

1955–
Harry & Helen's daughter. Insurance rater.

Douglas Ressman

1956–
Harry & Helen's son.

Maurice Leavitt

?
Ruth Ressman's husband. Dental supply business.

Marilyn Leavitt Moltz

1937–
Ruth & Maurice's daughter. High school teacher.

Lynda Leavitt Klein

1941–
Ruth & Maurice's daughter.

Pessin

Hinda Pessin Ressman

1850–1937
Matriarch. Daughter of Harry Pessin and Esther Skolnick; crossed with David Moses.

Aaron Harry / Harry Pessin

Deceased
Hinda's father; described in the family notes as a chazan and shochet.

Esther Skolnick Pessin

Deceased
Hinda's mother.

Nathan Pessin

Deceased
Hinda's brother; remembered as a magid, or storyteller.

Vanetsky

Louis Vanetsky

1868–1930

Junk peddler in Englewood, Chicago.
Rose's father.

Machla / Mishila Mary Rifkin Vanetsky

1870–deceased

Rose's mother. Died after gallbladder surgery.

Rose Vanetsky Ressman

1889–1975

Only surviving child of Louis & Machla.
Married Leon Ressman.

Bailin / Beilen

David Beilen

?–1905

Rachel's husband. Died of tuberculosis at 38.

Esther Bailin Levy

1891–?

Rachel & David's daughter.

Bessie Bailin Kritzberg

1892–1977

Rachel & David's daughter.

Eva Bailin Herman

1895–1951

Rachel & David's daughter.

Joseph Bailin

1897–1958

Rachel & David's son. Renamed family Beilen → Bailin.

Bertha Bailin Goldstein

1900–?

Rachel & David's daughter.

Sadie Bailin

1902–1969

Rachel & David's daughter. Lived with lifelong intellectual disability after measles in infancy.

Abram Bailin

1905--1956

Rachel & David's youngest, only one born in America.

David M. Bailin

1927-

Joseph's son. Eagle Supply & Plastics.

Helen Bailin Lewis

1929-

Joseph's daughter. Married Ivor Lewis of Dublin.

Larry Jon Bailin

1952-

David's son. Attorney in Tampa.

Stuart Lee Bailin

1955-

David's son.

Jared 'Jerry' Hugh Bailin

1958-

David's son. Works at Ressman's Clothiers.

Jo Ann Bailin

1962-

David's daughter.

Shaindl Bailin

Died in infancy

First child of Rachel Ressman and David Beilen/Bailin.

Alexander / Alex Levy

1889-1967

Esther Bailin's husband; hat maker.

Frank Kritzberg

1888-1944

Bessie Bailin's husband; printer.

David Herman

?

Eva Bailin's husband; milkman.

Jeanette Leibowitz Bailin

?

Joseph Bailin's wife and friend of Eva Bailin.

Harry Goldstein

?

Bertha Bailin's husband; advertising executive and later grocer.

David 'Davey' Kritzberg

1913-

Bessie and Frank Kritzberg's son.

Mildred Kritzberg Sherr

1927-

Bessie and Frank Kritzberg's daughter.

Violet Schram Bailin

?

David M. Bailin's wife; met him at the University of Wisconsin.

Ivor Lewis

?

Helen Bailin's husband; native of Dublin and partner in Eagle Supply & Plastics.

Howard 'Ollie' Leslie

1914–

Esther Bailin's son.

Shirley Levy Kaplan

1917–

Esther Bailin's daughter.

David 'Buddy' Levy

1921–

Esther Bailin's son.

Robert Kaplan

1950–

Shirley & Bernard's son.

Susan Kaplan

1946–

Shirley & Bernard's daughter.

Bahcall

Isadore Bahcall

1880–1963

Rebecca's husband. Founded I. Bahcall, Inc.

Rose Bahcall Rosenzweig

1904–

Rebecca & Isadore's daughter.

Edward Bahcall

1907–1961

Rebecca & Isadore's son.

***Sarah 'Bebe' Bahcall
Balkansky***

1909–

Rebecca & Isadore's daughter.

Walter Rosenzweig

1903–1967

Rose's husband. From Bessemer, Michigan.

Donna Rosenzweig Ziven

1929–

Rose & Walter's daughter.

Richard Rosenzweig

1935–

Rose & Walter's son. Exec VP of Playboy Enterprises.

Dennis Bahcall

1934–

Edward's son. Family business.

Bernard Balkansky

1905–1979
Bebe's husband. Manitowoc, Wisconsin.

Ruth Kahn Bahcall

1908–1952
Edward Bahcall's wife.

Naomi Cohen Bahcall

?
Dennis Bahcall's wife, from Appleton.

Ruth Bahcall Shayne

1955–
Dennis and Naomi Bahcall's daughter.

Michael Bahcall

1957–
Dennis and Naomi Bahcall's son.

Lee Bahcall

1958–
Dennis and Naomi Bahcall's child.

Jerre Balkansky

1933–1941
Bebe and Bernard Balkansky's child; died at age eight.

David Balkansky

1937–
Bebe and Bernard Balkansky's son; worked for I. Bahcall, Inc.

Harlan Balkansky

1944–
Bebe and Bernard Balkansky's son; worked for I. Bahcall, Inc.

Miller / Malyn

Isreal Miller

before 1845–?

Joel's great-grandfather. Lithuania.

Harris Nathan Miller

1863–1946

Joel's grandfather. Lithuania → New Kensington, PA.

Mary Ethel Fairchild Rosenberg Miller

before 1880--1923

Harris's wife. Born in England.

Morris Louis Miller

1900–?

Harris's son. Joel's father.

Freida Rubin Miller

?

Morris Louis's wife. Joel's mother.

Marilyn Ethel Miller Summer

1928–

Joel's sister.

Joel F. Miller

1934–

DAD. Married Lois October 21, 1972 in Chicago.

Maizie Lee Miller

1973–

Lois & Joel's eldest. Born Tel Aviv.

Russell Jasun Miller

1978–

Lois & Joel's son. Born Phoenix.

Michaela Diane Brune Miller

?

Russell's wife. Mother of Jacob and Landon.

Ilene Davida Miller

1980–

Lois & Joel's youngest. Born Phoenix.

Jacob Shaw Miller

June 19, 2013–

Russell & Michaela's son. Lois's grandson.

Landon Andrew Miller

Nov 5, 2014–

Russell & Michaela's son. Lois's grandson.

Ozzie Boswell Miller

c. 2009–2025

Lois's granddog and beloved family grandchild. Passed in 2025 at age 16.

Edith Gertrude Miller Malyn

1898–1973

Joel's aunt. Married Morris Malyn.

Leah Miller

1896–

Child of Harris Nathan Miller and Mary Ethel Fairchild Rosenberg.

Benjamin Miller

1902–

Child of Harris Nathan Miller and Mary Ethel Fairchild Rosenberg.

David Miller

1904–

Child of Harris Nathan Miller and Mary Ethel Fairchild Rosenberg.

Sarah Miller

1906–

Child of Harris Nathan Miller and Mary Ethel Fairchild Rosenberg.

Katherine 'Katie/Kay' Miller

1906–

Child of Harris Nathan Miller and Mary Ethel Fairchild Rosenberg.

Carl Julius Miller

1919–

Child of Harris Nathan Miller and Mary Ethel Fairchild Rosenberg.

Nathan Malinovsky

Deceased

Earliest named ancestor in the related Malinovsky/Malyn pages.

Israel Malinovsky

1858–1921

Born in Plotzk, Poland/Russia; married Rebeca Lefchyk.

Rebeca Lefchyk Malinovsky

1853–1923

Israel Malinovsky's wife.

Morris Malyn (Malinovsky)

1892–1939

Edith's husband. From Plotzk, Poland.

Max Malyn / Malinovsky

?

Child of Israel Malinovsky and Rebeca Lefchyk.

Mary Malyn / Malinovsky

?

Child of Israel Malinovsky and Rebeca Lefchyk.

Sam Malyn / Malinovsky

?

Child of Israel Malinovsky and Rebeca Lefchyk.

Herbert Malyn

1921–

Edith & Morris's son.

Irving Malyn

1922–

Edith & Morris's son.

Milton Robert Malyn

1927–

Edith & Morris's son.

Albert Malyn

1930–
Edith & Morris's son.

Michael Harris Malyn

1947–
Herbert's son.

Marshall Joseph Eidinger

1944–
Joel's cousin (via aunt Katherine).

Harris Miller

1951–
Joel's cousin (via uncle Carl Julius).

Slafer

Sylvia Ressman Slafer

1910–2006
Leon & Rose's daughter. Lois's mother.

Marcus Slaferman / Slafer

1907/1909–1983
Sylvia's husband. Dress pattern grader.
Lois's father.

Howard Slafer

1939–
Sylvia & Marcus's son. Salesman for
Minolta.

Lois Ann Slafer Miller

1946–
MOM. Sylvia & Marcus's daughter.

Linda McNeil Slafer

?
Howard's first wife.

James Slafer

1963–
Howard & Linda's son.

Richard Slafer

1966–
Howard & Linda's son.

Ilana Slafer

1970–
Howard & Linda's daughter.

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Prepared as a print-ready family book source.